



2-22-2022 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oBNKB4fk0us
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Muncie Community Schools Board of School Trustees - Regular Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: February 22, 2022

Location: Muncie, Indiana

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order at [00:03:54](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mrs. Siales, Mrs. Barnes, Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Webb (Presiding Officer)
 - **Members Absent:** Bishop O'Neill, Mr. Heater

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of Allegiance [00:03:57](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** (Not explicitly detailed in this transcript segment).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:05:08 COVID-19 Guidance & Mask Mandate Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Dwikowski (Superintendent)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Dwikowski reported on new guidance from the Indiana Department of Health (effective February 23) which removes contact tracing and quarantine recommendations for schools, ends weekly case reporting, and eliminates the requirement for a negative test or doctor's note to return to school (replacing it with a standard 24-hour fever-free rule). Following consultations with local health officials (including Dr. Byrd and Dr. Voss), who confirmed dramatically declining positivity rates and low outbreak numbers during large events, it was recommended to make mask-wearing optional across schools (excluding buses, which remain under federal mandate) and to remove the vaccination requirement for school volunteers.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:08:35** (Board president noted the mask optionality effective immediately for attendees in the crowd **00:08:51**).
- **00:09:05 Longfellow Elementary School Report & Academic Presentation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Gary Moore, Principal of Longfellow Elementary School
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Principal Moore presented an enthusiastic update on Longfellow Elementary, highlighting whole-child development, daily student affirmations, professional learning communities (PLCs), guided reading, the pilot of "Guided Math," and i-Ready diagnostic growth metrics showing strong student progress. Board members praised the school's positive culture and discussed strategies to increase parent engagement.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information only; no formal board action required.
- **00:41:05 Student Poster Incident Report & Recommendations Acceptance**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Dwikowski
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Dwikowski reported that the independent report regarding the November student poster incident (conducted by Church, Church, Hittle + Antrim) was published to the district website. Administration outlined completed changes (listening circles, new security team, student advisory groups, mental health resource guides, diversity support) and upcoming actions (written policies on displaying student work, new mental health professionals via Meridian Health Services at Muncie Central, staff implicit bias training, and handbook updates).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:47:30** to accept the report and implement remaining recommendations.
- **00:54:42 Consent Agenda & Field Trip Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ms. Schneider / Administration

- **Deliberation Summary:** Ms. Schneider presented an out-of-state student field trip for 31 students and 3 adults to Washington D.C. and New York City scheduled for April 4<U+2013>8, 2022. She noted that \$2,800 in community donations was raised to fully or partially cover travel costs for students in need. The consent agenda also included routine donations and administrative items.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:01:02](#).
- **01:01:06 Financial Reports**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome (Chief Financial Officer)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome presented the January 2022 financial results. Key highlights included a strong cash balance of over \$35 million, continued state loan repayments at \$50,000 per month, steady payroll figures, and a projected surplus position for the year. He noted that the Operation Fund (\$12.6 million budgeted, down \$400,000 from the prior year) will absorb the primary impact of tax caps.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:03:30](#).
- **01:03:34 Permission to Advertise: Food Service Improvement Project**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Seeking permission to advertise bids for a cafeteria revamping project at Muncie Central High School (including equipment, tables, and flooring). Mr. Jerome noted the district's food service fund is currently overfunded by approximately \$2 million under State Department of Education child nutrition guidelines, necessitating an organized spending down of the fund.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:05:58](#).
- **01:06:02 Food Service Vendor Renewal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requesting a one-year rollover/renewal of the food service operating agreement with Chartwells.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:07:52](#).
- **01:07:56 Curriculum Handbook Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented updated course descriptions and single-off Career and Technical Education (CTE) pathway offerings at the high school for the upcoming school year.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:08:34](#).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [00:48:41](#) <U+2013> **Mr. Arnold:** Addressed the board regarding the mask mandate removal, congratulating the district and quoting Winston Churchill regarding decision-making processes.

- [00:51:25](#) <U+2013> **Mr. Hyatt:** Spoke regarding upcoming city council school board appointments, noting interest in qualified candidates applying.
 - [00:52:19](#) <U+2013> **Ms. Duke:** Commented on the mask mandate decision, expressed appreciation for the policy shift, and submitted a formal Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) request to district staff ([00:54:08](#)).
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Discussion regarding the upcoming state-mandated SAT testing for juniors on March 2, 2022, requiring e-learning for other grade levels.
 - Progress updates on facility projects (E.W.A. project tracking on schedule for completion by August 8, 2022).
 - Board members and administrators encouraged community volunteerism across district schools.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote ([01:21:24](#)).
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